

Capivaras

A game of secret bets in the Pantanal

The Pantanal wakes up...

In the humid heart of the Pantanal, a colony of capybaras is relaxing in the sun. The humans have arrived — each one wants to pet their favourite. But the capybaras are shy: if two humans approach at the same time, they scurry off immediately. Only the player who approaches **alone** gets to keep their capybara.

Joining a game

First time? Press **Tutorial** on the start screen or in the lobby: a 2-minute guided tour with two practice rounds against bots that shows you the game screen and the rules in action. It doesn't create any table and nothing counts.

- **Multiplayer tables** (Table 1 to Table 5) — up to 6 human players per table. The first player to join becomes the host and is the one who clicks "**Start Game**" once at least 2 players are seated.
- **Solo table (vs 2 bots)** — you join alone and the game starts right away, against two bots. This table is always private, created just for you.
- If your connection drops mid-game, you have **45 seconds** to reopen the page — your seat stays reserved.

Objective

Finish the game with more points than the other players. Points come from three sources: the capybaras you collect, the bird token and the water-lily bonus.

Each round

Each round, **as many cards as there are players** are placed on the table, face up and labelled with a letter (A, B, C...). In secret, every player picks **one** of those cards to bet on. There are no turns and no playing order: nobody sees the others' choices, so betting earlier or later gives no advantage. Once everyone is ready, all bets are revealed at the same time:

- **Alone** — were you the only one who picked that card? It's yours!
- **Tie** — did more than one player pick the same card? Nobody wins it — the capybaras scattered and the card goes to the discard pile.
- **No bets** — did nobody pick a card? It also goes to the discard pile.

At a multiplayer table you have as much time as you need to bet while you stay connected — an automatic (random) bet is only placed on your behalf if you disconnect mid-round. At the Solo table, the bots bet on their own, a few seconds after the round starts.

The yellow bird

Some cards have a yellow bird drawn on them.

- The **first** time anyone collects a bird card, they receive the **bird token (+5 points)**.
- To **steal** it, you need **more** bird cards than the current holder (at least one more) — matching them isn't enough.
- **Ties don't move the token.** If two players overtake the holder in the same round and are tied with each other, the holder keeps it; if one of them is ahead of the other, that player takes it.
- **Tie on the first bird card:** the token stays on the table and goes to the first player who has more bird cards than the tie (if the tie was at one card, whoever gets to two first takes it).

The water lilies

Certain cards have coloured water lilies. Collect all **four colours** — they don't need to be on the same card — to earn a **+10 point** bonus.

Yellow	Red	White	Blue
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The deck

The deck has **36 cards**, showing between 1 and 5 capybaras each:

Capybaras on card	Number of cards
1	6
2	13
3	11
4	4
5	2

The deck is **played through twice**: the first time it runs out, the discard pile (the cards nobody won, through a tie or no bets) is reshuffled and play continues. Won cards stay with whoever won them and never come back. The second time the deck runs out, the game ends and final scores are tallied.

Final scoring

Source	Points
Each capybara on the cards you collected (sum of each card's value)	equal to the number of capybaras on the card
Holding the bird token at the end of the game	+5
Holding all 4 water-lily colours	+10

Whoever has the most points overall wins. In case of a tie for the highest score, the first player with that score is shown as the winner.

Unlike the physical game, you don't have to wait for the end to do the maths: the player panels show the score in real time, already including the bird token and the water-lily bonus.

Tips

- Keep track of which water-lily colours you already have and which you're missing — it can be worth risking a lower-value card if you only need one more colour for the +10 bonus.
- Keep an eye on who holds the bird token (and how many bird cards each player has) to judge whether trying to steal it is worth it.
- Always betting on the highest-value card doesn't always pay off — if it's the obvious pick, another player is likely to choose it too, and the card will slip away from both of you.
- At the end of a game, the host of a multiplayer table can start a new match with "Play Again"; at the Solo table that option is always available.

These rules match the "How to play" panel inside the game itself — you can check it at any point during a match.

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